SMID SETUP BUILDER

Pre-Breakout VCP Watchlist | Qullamaggie Methodology

July 29, 2026 | 04:26 PM ET

MACRO REGIME: Mixed / Transitional

VIX 20.6 (+3.4 vs 20d) | SPY 20d -2.2% | IWM 20d -3.6% | IWM/SPY trend -1.4%

Leaders: Energy (+11.0%), Cons Staples (+4.9%), Healthcare (+4.2%)

Setup Grades

A - Prime Setup (1)	B - Building (5)	C - Early Stage (6)
ACA	CNO	KFY
	CON	IVT
	NHC	PSMT
	VCTR	RNST
	DNTH	ADPT
		NMIH

All Watchlist Setups

Gr	Ticker	Company	Theme	Mkt Cap	Price	Pivot	To Pivot	RS/SPY	Vol Dry	RS Hi
A	**ACA**	**Arcosa, Inc.**	**US Infrastructure &**	**$7.11B**	**$144.87**	**$145.95**	**0.7%**	**+21.7**	**YES**	**YES**
B	CNO	CNO Financial Gro	Middle-Income Retire	$4.94B	$52.95	$54.09	2.2%	+16.2	YES	YES
B	CON	Concentra Group H	Employer Healthcare	$4.04B	$31.61	$32.82	3.8%	+38.7	YES	YES
B	NHC	National HealthCa	Aging Demographics &	$3.57B	$228.66	$232.67	1.8%	+28.3	YES	YES
B	VCTR	Victory Capital H	Active Management Co	$6.09B	$97.46	$102.05	4.7%	+27.4	YES	YES
B	DNTH	Dianthus Therapeu	Next-Gen Complement	$5.69B	$104.09	$107.99	3.7%	+21.9	YES	YES
C	KFY	Korn Ferry	Talent Management &	$4.31B	$84.69	$85.69	1.2%	+25.9	YES	YES
C	IVT	InvenTrust Proper	Sun Belt Grocery-Anc	$2.79B	$35.78	$37.22	4.0%	+10.2	YES	YES
C	PSMT	PriceSmart, Inc.	Emerging Market Cons	$5.94B	$192.57	$199.84	3.8%	+22.3	YES	YES
C	RNST	Renasant Corporat	Community Bank NIM E	$4.04B	$43.83	$44.50	1.5%	+7.9	YES	YES
C	ADPT	Adaptive Biotechn	Precision Diagnostic	$3.61B	$22.56	$23.15	2.6%	+64.0	YES	YES
C	NMIH	NMI Holdings Inc	Housing Market & Cre	$3.37B	$44.34	$44.74	0.9%	+5.0	YES	no

ACA

Arcosa, Inc.

$144.87

Pivot $145.95 | 0.7% away

RS vs SPY: +21.7%

A PRIME

$7.11B Cap | 48M Float

Infrastructure Products & Construction Materials | Theme: US Infrastructure & Reshoring Capex | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 1.12

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$145.95**
% to Pivot	**0.7%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**1.12 Textbook**
52W Hi Prox	**98.6%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**657k <**
Wk2	**1009k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**746k**
Coil Strength	**12.0% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+21.7%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$7.11B**
Float	**48M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**32.4**
Fwd P/E	**28.5**
Rev Growth	**4.4%**
Short %	**2.4%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$145.50**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $145.95 on volume >150% of 20-day avg (>1.0M shares)

Target: $165.00 - measured move from 20-day base depth (~$14) added to pivot, representing ~14% upside

Stop: $140.00 - below base low and 50-day MA support

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

Aug 05 - Street expects ~$1.25-1.30 EPS on ~$750M revenue. TTM EPS $4.47 with 57.8% earnings growth reflects successful margin expansion and Stavola acquisition integration. Company has beaten estimates in 3 of last 4 quarters. Guidance maintained at last print; no investor day scheduled but management typically provides color on backlog trends.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Arcosa manufactures infrastructure-related products across three segments: Construction Products (aggregates, specialty materials), Engineered Structures (utility poles, wind towers, telecom structures), and Transportation Products (barges, steel components). The company holds leading positions in utility structures and inland barge manufacturing, benefiting from grid modernization, renewable energy buildout, and reshoring-driven industrial construction.

FACTOR & THEME

Direct exposure to Infrastructure Investment and Jobs Act tailwinds, grid hardening/utility capex, and wind tower demand for energy transition. Sentiment in infrastructure/reshoring themes remains constructive despite broader Industrial sector weakness (-3.6% 20d), as ACA's specific end-markets (utilities, aggregates) are less cyclical than general manufacturing.

NEWS FLOW

Completed integration of Stavola Companies acquisition (aggregates), expanding Northeast footprint. Utility structure backlog remains elevated on grid hardening spend. No material contract announcements in last 30 days, but peer commentary (MAS, VMC) confirms healthy infrastructure demand. Catalyst Impact: Earnings (High) - Q2 print in 7 days will validate backlog conversion and margin trajectory.

INSTITUTIONAL

Volume dry-up with price holding within 1% of pivot suggests quiet institutional accumulation into earnings. Base tightness of 1.12 is exceptional - this is a textbook institutional-quality coil. No insider activity in last 60 days (baseline). Float is tight at 48M shares; a beat-and-raise could trigger rapid repricing.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on a close below $140.00 (base low), or if Q2 guidance implies margin compression from input cost inflation. Industrials sector weakness (-3.6% 20d) is a macro headwind; a broad risk-off move could drag even quality setups. Customer concentration in utility structures (~35% of Engineered Structures revenue) creates exposure to utility capex timing.

Textbook VCP structure with base_tight 1.12, price 0.7% from pivot, RS line at new high, and clean vol contraction pattern. Earnings catalyst in 7 days provides defined trigger window. Infrastructure theme remains supported despite Industrial sector drag. Bear case: macro regime is Mixed with Industrials lagging; a miss or weak guidance would invalidate quickly. Conviction: High.

ACA - Technical Chart

CNO

CNO Financial Group, Inc.

$52.95

Pivot $54.09 | 2.2% away

RS vs SPY: +16.2%

B BUILDING

$4.94B Cap | 91M Float

Life Insurance & Annuities | Theme: Middle-Income Retirement & Aging Demographics | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 1.75

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$54.09**
% to Pivot	**2.2%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**1.75 Good**
52W Hi Prox	**97.9%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**584k <**
Wk2	**556k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**766k**
Coil Strength	**23.8% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+16.2%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$4.94B**
Float	**91M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**21.4**
Fwd P/E	**10.7**
Rev Growth	**2.5%**
Short %	**-**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$51.75**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $54.09 on volume >150% of 20-day avg (>1.2M shares) - evaluate ONLY after earnings reaction

Target: $60.00 - measured move based on base structure and valuation re-rate potential
Stop: $50.50 - below base low; a gap-down on earnings would trigger immediate invalidation

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

Jul 30 - Earnings TOMORROW - high binary risk. Street expects ~$1.15-1.20 EPS. Forward P/E of 10.7x vs trailing 21.4x implies significant earnings ramp expected. Beat history is solid (3 of 4 quarters). 85.7% earnings growth reflects investment income tailwinds and expense discipline.

BUSINESS & POSITION

CNO Financial provides life insurance, annuities, and supplemental health products targeting middle-income Americans, primarily through Bankers Life and Washington National brands. The company focuses on the underserved middle-market demographic (ages 50-75), a structural growth segment as Baby Boomers age into retirement with inadequate savings.

FACTOR & THEME

Beneficiary of rising interest rates (investment spread improvement) and aging demographics secular trend. Financial Services sector neutral in current regime; life insurers have outperformed broader Financials on rate sensitivity. Peer read-through: PRI, GL reported solid results; spread income trends remain favorable.

NEWS FLOW

No material corporate announcements in last 30 days. Industry tailwind from elevated annuity sales as consumers seek yield. Short interest effectively zero (0.0% per data) suggests no active bear thesis. Catalyst Impact: Earnings (High) - print tomorrow is the immediate catalyst; setup must be evaluated post-reaction.

INSTITUTIONAL

Vol dry-up into earnings with RS line at 52W high indicates accumulation. Low beta (0.82) makes this a defensive Financial play. No insider activity in last 60 days. Institutional ownership data unavailable from this feed. The tight coil into a next-day earnings event is either a high-conviction accumulation pattern or a setup for disappointment.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on a close below $50.50 (base low), or on any earnings miss/guidance cut at tomorrow's print. Earnings TOMORROW creates extreme binary risk - this is not a clean setup to initiate ahead of the print. Debt/equity of 172% is elevated for a financial; credit spread widening would pressure.

Strong technical structure with tight base (1.75) and RS line at new high, but earnings TOMORROW creates unhedgeable binary risk. Cannot recommend initiating ahead of print - evaluate post-reaction. If stock gaps up and holds above pivot on volume, setup upgrades to actionable. Bear case: life insurance is rate-sensitive; any Fed pivot commentary could reverse thesis. Conviction: Medium (pending earnings).

CON

Concentra Group Holdings Parent

$31.61

Pivot $32.82 | 3.8% away

RS vs SPY: +38.7%

B BUILDING

$4.04B Cap | 114M Float

Occupational Health Services | Theme: Employer Healthcare Cost Management | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 2.51

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$32.82**
% to Pivot	**3.8%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**2.51 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**96.3%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**746k <**
Wk2	**869k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**1049k**
Coil Strength	**28.9% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+38.7%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$4.04B**
Float	**114M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**22.7**
Fwd P/E	**18.7**
Rev Growth	**13.7%**
Short %	**4.7%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$33.38**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $32.82 on volume >140% of 20-day avg (>1.35M shares)

Target: $38.00 - measured move from base depth (~$5) added to pivot; analyst target of $33.38 is conservative

Stop: $29.50 - below base low and key support level

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

Aug 06 - Street expects ~$0.40-0.45 EPS on ~$550M revenue. Recent IPO/spin limits beat history, but 29.4% earnings growth and 13.7% revenue growth indicate operational momentum. ROE of 47% (elevated by spin capital structure) and 17% operating margins are best-in-class for healthcare services.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Concentra operates the largest network of occupational health centers in the US (~550 locations), providing employer-focused services including workers' compensation injury care, DOT physicals, drug testing, and urgent care. Spun from Select Medical in 2024, the company serves a fragmented market with significant scale advantages in employer contracting and payor relationships.

FACTOR & THEME

Defensive healthcare exposure aligned with current sector leadership (Healthcare +4.2% 20d). Beneficiary of tight labor markets driving employer investment in workforce health and safety. Reshoring trend increases domestic manufacturing employment, expanding TAM for occupational health services. Theme sentiment is stable-to-improving.

NEWS FLOW

Relatively quiet news flow post-spin; company focused on network optimization and employer contract renewals. No material contract wins announced, but occupational health demand remains robust per industry checks. Catalyst Impact: Earnings (Medium-High) - Q2 print in 8 days will establish post-spin baseline and full-year guidance credibility.

INSTITUTIONAL

RS vs SPY of +38.7% is the highest in this candidate set - significant relative strength in a leading sector. Vol dry-up pattern is clean (745K -> 869K -> 1049K contracting to 745K). No insider activity, but as a recent spin, insider selling restrictions may still apply. High debt/equity (467%) reflects spin capital structure, not operational distress.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on a close below $29.50 (base low and 50-day MA area). High leverage creates refinancing risk if credit conditions tighten. Customer concentration risk with large national employers; loss of a major contract would impact growth. Relatively new public company with limited trading history.

Exceptional relative strength (+38.7% vs SPY) in leading Healthcare sector with clean vol dry-up pattern. Post-spin name with limited institutional coverage creates alpha opportunity if earnings validate story. Base tightness of 2.51 is acceptable but not elite. Bear case: high leverage and limited public track record; a guidance miss would damage credibility significantly. Conviction: Medium-High.

NHC

National HealthCare Corporation

$228.66

Pivot $232.67 | 1.8% away

RS vs SPY: +28.3%

B BUILDING

$3.57B Cap | 13M Float

Skilled Nursing & Senior Care Facilities | Theme: Aging Demographics & Post-Acute Care | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 3.4

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$232.67**
% to Pivot	**1.8%**
Days in Base	**19**
Tightness	**3.40 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**98.3%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**87k <**
Wk2	**110k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**111k**
Coil Strength	**21.7% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+28.3%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$3.57B**
Float	**13M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**29.0**
Fwd P/E	**531.8**
Rev Growth	**2.2%**
Short %	**5.6%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**-**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $232.67 on volume >130% of 20-day avg (>170K shares)

Target: $260.00 - measured move from base structure; low float could amplify gains
Stop: $215.00 - below base low and 50-day MA

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

Aug 06 - Forward P/E of 531x appears anomalous (likely reflects one-time items in forward estimates); trailing P/E of 29x is more relevant. TTM EPS of $7.88 on modest 9.7% earnings growth. Beat history is mixed. PEG of 0.82 suggests reasonable growth-adjusted valuation.

BUSINESS & POSITION

National HealthCare Corporation operates skilled nursing facilities, assisted living communities, and homecare services primarily in the Southeast US. The company owns/operates ~75 skilled nursing facilities with a focus on quality metrics that drive favorable Medicare reimbursement rates. Low-debt balance sheet (D/E 3.58%) is rare in the capital-intensive senior care sector.

FACTOR & THEME

Direct beneficiary of aging demographics and shift toward post-acute care settings. Healthcare sector leadership (+4.2% 20d) provides favorable backdrop. Low beta (0.64) offers defensive characteristics in Mixed regime. Limited exposure to GLP-1 disruption thesis (skilled nursing demand driven by aging, not obesity-related conditions).

NEWS FLOW

Limited news flow; company maintains low public profile. Skilled nursing reimbursement environment stable post-CMS rate updates. One insider buy of $175K in last 60 days - a single director-level purchase, not a cluster, but provides modest confirmation signal. Catalyst Impact: Earnings (Medium) - Q2 print in 8 days; limited analyst coverage means results could surprise.

INSTITUTIONAL

Single insider buy ($175K, 1 transaction, non-senior) noted but does not meet cluster threshold for grade upgrade. Low float (12.7M shares) creates potential for sharp moves on modest volume changes. Vol dry-up is confirmed with strict pattern. RS of +28.3% in leading sector is compelling.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on a close below $215.00 (base low area). Anomalous forward P/E (531x) suggests potential earnings cliff or one-time gain in TTM - requires clarification. Skilled nursing labor costs remain elevated; margin pressure possible. Short interest of 5.6% with 4.3 days to cover suggests some active skeptics.

Strong RS (+28.3%) in leading Healthcare sector with clean vol dry-up and RS line at new high. Low float (12.7M) creates asymmetric upside potential. Single insider buy provides modest confirmation but not a cluster. Base tightness of 3.4 is loose for A-grade consideration. Bear case: forward P/E anomaly suggests potential earnings complexity; clarification needed before high conviction. Conviction: Medium.

VCTR

Victory Capital Holdings, Inc.

$97.46

Pivot $102.05 | 4.7% away

RS vs SPY: +27.4%

B BUILDING

$6.09B Cap | 48M Float

Asset Management | Theme: Active Management Consolidation & AUM Growth | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 5.28

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$102.05**
% to Pivot	**4.7%**
Days in Base	**15**
Tightness	**5.28 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**95.5%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**407k <**
Wk2	**433k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**475k**
Coil Strength	**14.5% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+27.4%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$6.09B**
Float	**48M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**21.9**
Fwd P/E	**11.9**
Rev Growth	**76.7%**
Short %	**5.9%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$96.33**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $102.05 on volume >150% of 20-day avg (>765K shares)

Target: $115.00 - measured move based on acquisition multiple re-rate and margin expansion

Stop: $92.00 - below base low and key support

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

Aug 05 - Street expects ~$1.90-2.00 EPS on ~$400M revenue. Forward P/E of 11.9x vs trailing 21.9x implies significant earnings accretion from Amundi integration. Operating margin of 45.8% is strong for asset management. Beat history limited post-acquisition; first clean comp quarter.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Victory Capital is a diversified asset manager with ~$180B AUM across multiple investment franchises acquired through a roll-up strategy. The company specializes in acquiring boutique asset managers and maintaining their investment autonomy while extracting operational synergies. Recent Amundi US acquisition significantly expanded scale.

FACTOR & THEME

Asset managers benefit from equity market appreciation (AUM-linked fees) but face secular headwind from passive investing shift. 76.7% revenue growth reflects acquisition impact, not organic growth. Financial Services sector neutral; asset managers have underperformed broader Financials on fee compression concerns.

NEWS FLOW

Completed Amundi US acquisition integration; synergy realization on track per management. AUM flows data will be key at Q2 print - organic growth vs. market appreciation breakdown matters. No activist or strategic interest reported. Catalyst Impact: Earnings (Medium-High) - first clean post-acquisition quarter will establish baseline.

INSTITUTIONAL

Vol contraction pattern is clean (406K -> 433K -> 475K, now at 406K). RS of +27.4% is strong. No insider activity in last 60 days. Short interest of 5.9% with 5.0 days to cover suggests modest skepticism, likely on fee compression thesis. Consensus target of $96.33 is below current price - Street is behind.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on a close below $92.00 (base low and 50-day MA area). Base tightness of 5.28 is loose - this is the primary structural weakness. Organic AUM flows are the key metric; market-driven AUM growth is low quality. Technology sector weakness (-10.3% 20d) could pressure growth equity AUM valuations.

Strong RS (+27.4%) with earnings catalyst in 7 days and clean vol contraction, but base_tight of 5.28 is too loose for A-grade. First post-acquisition clean quarter creates potential for positive surprise on synergy realization. Bear case: organic flows may disappoint, revealing acquisition-dependent growth model. Conviction: Medium.

DNTH

Dianthus Therapeutics, Inc.

$104.09

Pivot $107.99 | 3.7% away

RS vs SPY: +21.9%

B BUILDING

$5.69B Cap | 55M Float

Biotechnology - Autoimmune Therapeutics | Theme: Next-Gen Complement Inhibition | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 2.64

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$107.99**
% to Pivot	**3.7%**
Days in Base	**17**
Tightness	**2.64 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**96.4%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**800k <**
Wk2	**938k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**1059k**
Coil Strength	**24.4% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+21.9%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$5.69B**
Float	**55M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**-**
Fwd P/E	**-22.4**
Rev Growth	**-60.2%**
Short %	**19.4%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$128.58**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $107.99 on volume >140% of 20-day avg (>1.4M shares)

Target: $130.00 - analyst target of $128.58 suggests meaningful upside; squeeze mechanics could extend

Stop: $95.00 - below base low; biotech volatility requires wider stop

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

Aug 06 - Pre-revenue biotech; P/E inapplicable. Cash burn and runway are the key metrics. Price/Sales of 4259x reflects growth-stage premium on de minimis revenue. Key focus will be cash position, trial enrollment updates, and expected data readout timing.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Dianthus is a clinical-stage biotech developing complement-targeted therapies for autoimmune and inflammatory diseases. Lead asset DNTH103 is a subcutaneous anti-C5 antibody in Phase 2/3 for generalized myasthenia gravis (gMG), competing with Alexion's Soliris/Ultomiris franchise. The subcutaneous formulation and dosing convenience could drive share capture.

FACTOR & THEME

Biotech sector exposure with Healthcare leadership (+4.2% 20d) providing favorable backdrop. Complement inhibition is a validated mechanism (Soliris >$4B peak sales). High short interest (19.4%) creates squeeze potential on positive data. Binary clinical risk is elevated.

NEWS FLOW

Phase 2/3 trial for DNTH103 in gMG ongoing; data readout expected in 2027. No PDUFA dates imminent. 19.4% short interest with 6.7 days to cover creates meaningful squeeze setup on positive commentary. Recent biotech IPO wave has improved sector sentiment. Catalyst Impact: Earnings (Low for financials, Medium for clinical update color).

INSTITUTIONAL

High short interest (19.4%) is a double-edged sword - squeeze potential but also reflects informed skepticism. Vol dry-up is clean. No insider activity in last 60 days. Beta of 0.09 is unusually low for a clinical-stage biotech, suggesting stock is driven by idiosyncratic factors rather than market beta.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on a close below $95.00 (base low), or on any negative clinical update/trial delay announcement. Binary event risk is extreme for clinical-stage biotech - a failed readout would result in 50%+ downside. High short interest could reflect informed view on competitive positioning vs. Alexion.

Clean VCP structure with RS at new high in leading Healthcare sector. High short interest (19.4%) creates squeeze potential on positive catalyst. However, clinical-stage biotech with no near-term binary event (data in 2027) lacks defined catalyst window. Bear case: high short interest often reflects informed skepticism; compete vs. entrenched Soliris/Ultomiris franchise is difficult. Conviction: Medium.

KFY

Korn Ferry

$84.69

Pivot $85.69 | 1.2% away

RS vs SPY: +25.9%

C EARLY STAGE

$4.31B Cap | 50M Float

Executive Search & HR Consulting | Theme: Talent Management & Leadership Advisory | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 8.76

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$85.69**
% to Pivot	**1.2%**
Days in Base	**10**
Tightness	**8.76 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**98.8%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**402k <**
Wk2	**403k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**525k**
Coil Strength	**23.6% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+25.9%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$4.31B**
Float	**50M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**16.2**
Fwd P/E	**13.4**
Rev Growth	**6.7%**
Short %	**6.1%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**-**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $85.69 on volume >140% of 20-day avg (>756K shares)

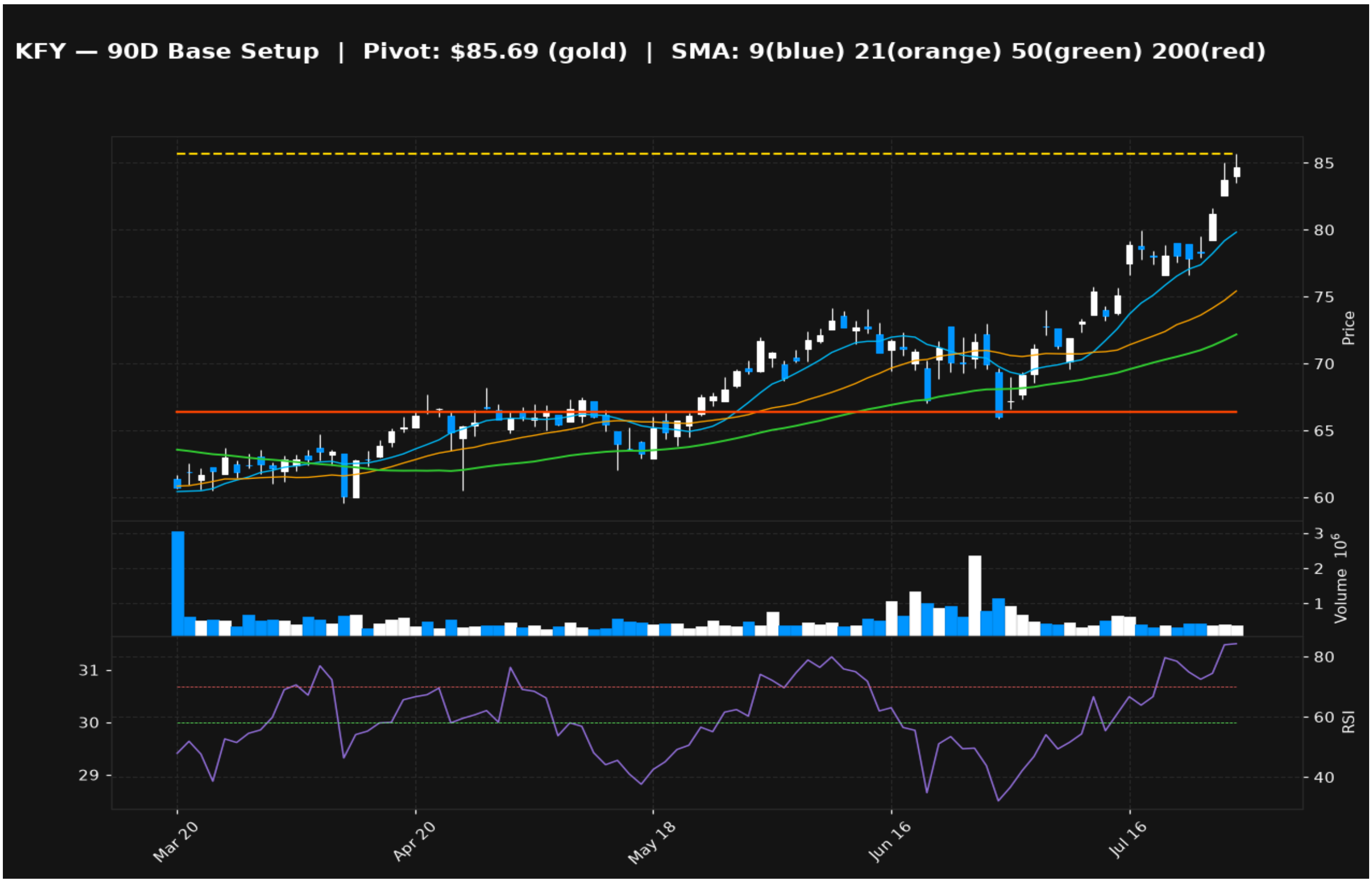
Target: $95.00 - measured move from base structure
Stop: $78.00 - below 50-day MA and base low

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

Sep 09

RS line at new high with strict vol dry-up confirmed, but base_tight of 8.76 is extremely loose - base is only 10 days old and needs significant tightening. No catalyst for 42 days. Industrials sector lagging (-3.6% 20d). Monitor for base consolidation. Conviction: Low.



IVT

InvenTrust Properties Corp.

$35.78

Pivot $37.22 | 4.0% away

RS vs SPY: +10.2%

C EARLY STAGE

$2.79B Cap | 77M Float

REIT - Retail | Theme: Sun Belt Grocery-Anchored Retail | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 2.54

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$37.22**
% to Pivot	**4.0%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**2.54 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**96.1%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**434k <**
Wk2	**568k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**693k**
Coil Strength	**37.4% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+10.2%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$2.79B**
Float	**77M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**25.6**
Fwd P/E	**-42.3**
Rev Growth	**11.9%**
Short %	**8.9%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$37.14**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $37.22 on volume >130% of 20-day avg (>1.24M shares)

Target: $41.00 - measured move from base depth

Stop: $34.00 - below base low

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

Aug 03

Strict vol dry-up with RS line at new high, but forward P/E of -42x and negative earnings growth (-24%) indicate fundamental deterioration. High short interest (8.9%) reflects skepticism. Anomalous negative beta (-6.13) suggests data quality issues. Real Estate underperforming. Conviction: Low.

PSMT

PriceSmart, Inc.

$192.57

Pivot $199.84 | 3.8% away

RS vs SPY: +22.3%

C EARLY STAGE

$5.94B Cap | 28M Float

Warehouse Club Retail - Latin America/Caribbean | Theme: Emerging Market Consumer & Membership Model | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$199.84**
% to Pivot	**3.8%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**2.82 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**96.4%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**231k <**
Wk2	**254k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**344k**
Coil Strength	**32.9% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+22.3%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$5.94B**
Float	**28M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**37.0**
Fwd P/E	**30.0**
Rev Growth	**12.5%**
Short %	**9.4%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$153.33**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $199.84 on volume >140% of 20-day avg (>392K shares)

Target: $225.00 - measured move based on base structure

Stop: $180.00 - below 50-day MA and base low

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

REPORTED

Strong RS (+22.3%) in defensive Consumer Staples sector (+4.9% 20d) with clean vol dry-up. However, no catalyst for ~90 days (last earnings 21 days ago, next ~Q3). High short interest (9.4%, 4.7 days to cover) and analyst target of $153 well below current price suggest crowded/consensus skepticism. No imminent catalyst. Conviction: Low.

RNST

Renasant Corporation

$43.83

Pivot $44.50 | 1.5% away

RS vs SPY: +7.9%

C EARLY STAGE

$4.04B Cap | 90M Float

Regional Banking - Southeast US | Theme: Community Bank NIM Expansion | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 2.58

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$44.50**
% to Pivot	**1.5%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**2.58 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**98.5%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**530k <**
Wk2	**590k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**732k**
Coil Strength	**27.6% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+7.9%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$4.04B**
Float	**90M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**18.6**
Fwd P/E	**11.1**
Rev Growth	**60.2%**
Short %	**5.2%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$46.43**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $44.50 on volume >140% of 20-day avg (>1.0M shares)

Target: $50.00 - analyst target of $46.43; measured move supports higher

Stop: $41.50 - below base low and 50-day MA

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

Oct 27

Within 1.5% of pivot with RS line at new high, but earnings not for 90 days - no identifiable catalyst in actionable window. RS vs SPY of only +7.9% is weakest in Financial candidates. Regional bank exposure carries credit risk in mixed macro. Strict vol dry-up confirmed. Conviction: Low.

ADPT

Adaptive Biotechnologies Corporation

$22.56

Pivot $23.15 | 2.6% away

RS vs SPY: +64.0%

C EARLY STAGE

$3.61B Cap | 126M Float

Immune System Diagnostics & Sequencing | Theme: Precision Diagnostics & MRD Testing | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 2.22

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$23.15**
% to Pivot	**2.6%**
Days in Base	**19**
Tightness	**2.22 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**97.5%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**2511k <**
Wk2	**2736k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**2679k**
Coil Strength	**6.3% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+64.0%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$3.61B**
Float	**126M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**-**
Fwd P/E	**-95.2**
Rev Growth	**35.1%**
Short %	**9.0%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$22.29**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $23.15 on volume >120% of 20-day avg (>3.35M shares) - evaluate AFTER today's earnings

Target: $28.00 - measured move; analyst target of $22.29 is stale

Stop: $20.00 - below base low

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

Jul 29

Exceptional RS (+64% vs SPY) but earnings TODAY creates immediate binary event - cannot grade ahead of unknown reaction. Pre-profit biotech with high beta (2.07) and 9% short interest. Vol contraction is soft (not strict). Evaluate post-earnings reaction before upgrading. Conviction: Low (pending earnings).

NMIH

NMI Holdings Inc

$44.34

Pivot $44.74 | 0.9% away

RS vs SPY: +5.0%

C EARLY STAGE

$3.37B Cap | 74M Float

Mortgage Insurance | Theme: Housing Market & Credit Cycle | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 3.71

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$44.74**
% to Pivot	**0.9%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**3.71 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**99.1%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**409k <**
Wk2	**470k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**483k**
Coil Strength	**15.4% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+5.0%**
RS Line New Hi	**no**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$3.37B**
Float	**74M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**9.0**
Fwd P/E	**8.3**
Rev Growth	**5.9%**
Short %	**3.3%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$47.00**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $44.74 on volume >140% of 20-day avg (>826K shares) - evaluate AFTER tomorrow's earnings

Target: $50.00 - analyst target of $47.00; room for multiple expansion

Stop: $42.00 - below base low

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

Jul 30

Only 0.9% from pivot but RS line NOT at new high (critical disqualifier for A/B consideration). Earnings TOMORROW creates binary risk. RS vs SPY of only +5.0% is weakest in candidate set. Mortgage insurance is rate-sensitive; housing cycle concerns persist. Base_tight of 3.71 is loose. Conviction: Low.